

Cyclical theory of social change

- > Ibn-i-khaldun propounded that the change in human society follows clock-wise pattern and a circle is completed and repeated after almost 120 years in a given society.
- > There are fixed, definite, clear and standardized stages of this cycle.
 - > Each stage having a peculiar economic, social, demographic, religious and political characteristics.
- > Each stage having an average duration of about 40 years

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There are Three Stages of cyclic theory

- 1) Growth Stage
- 2) Developmental Stage
- 3) Decay Stage

Growth Stage

- a) This is society's initial stage of growth, its population is not politically conscious.
- b) People have primary group relations in most of their daily life situation.
- c) There is no regular military force or established state.
- d) Kinship remains dominant over individual interests
- e) There are potentialities in the population for making the society stronger and richer in all walks of life
- f) There is a solidarity and cohesion among the members of Society

Developmental Stage

- a) During the second stage of "development" the society become stronger in economic, political, social and such other fields.
- b) There is presence of a stronger government with well organized military force.
- c) Trade, commerce and other economic activities flourish in such societies.
- d) There is a hold of primary groups over the behaviour of an average person.
- e) The commoners enjoy amenities of life to a reasonable extent.
- f) The society is strong enough to face any outside aggression.
- g) People try to extend their political power over neighbouring societies.

Decay Stage

- a) The commoners start considering that the taxes are a burden.
- b) The rulers and chiefs do not have real political hold over an average person.
- c) Unity and cohesion are slackened.
- d) People start thinking Individually and there is a decline in all the social institution of Society
- e) This depression results in the creation of a Sense of disorganization and confusion in the mind of people
- f) Thus the society attains the same Position from where it started 120 years back